



A 15-minute walkthrough · *for Alex*

DOMAIN · HOSTING · SETUP

FOR ALEX

Hi! Here's everything *you'll do on your end.*

Total time: about 15 minutes. Total cost: around \$11 for the year, paid to one place (Porkbun), in your name, on your card. I'll handle the rest from there.

The site is built and ready. The only piece missing is your domain (the web address people will type to find you). You'll buy that yourself, in your own name, so the business stays yours, no matter what. Then I'll point the site at it.

This guide walks through the three small things you need to do, in order. If anything looks weird mid-step, just text me and I'll talk you through it.

THE PLAN, AT A GLANCE

Step 1. You buy **elephantaes.com** on Porkbun (~\$11/yr).

Step 2. You text me to say it's bought.

Step 3. I send you two short DNS records. You paste them in. Site goes live.

Buy **elephantaes.com** *on Porkbun.*

Porkbun is a domain registrar. They sell the address; that's it. Your business stays yours; if you ever leave them, the domain comes with you.

01

SIGN UP

Make a Porkbun account

1. Go to **porkbun.com**
2. Top right, click **Sign Up**
3. Use your real email (this is the account that owns the domain forever)
4. Pick a strong password and save it somewhere safe (a password manager, your phone's notes, anywhere you won't lose it)

02

SEARCH

Search for the domain

1. On the homepage, type **elephantaes.com** in the big search bar
2. If it's available, you'll see a price (~\$11/yr for a .com)
3. Click **Add to Cart**, then **Checkout**

03

CHECKOUT

Watch for these at checkout

- ✓ **WHOIS Privacy: ON.** Free at Porkbun. Hides your home address from public lookup.
- ✓ **Auto-renew: ON** (recommended). One less thing to remember next year.
- ✗ **Skip the email hosting upsell** (\$24/yr). You don't need it. We can add email later when you want it.
- ✗ **Skip the website builder upsell.** We already built your site.
- ✗ **Skip the SSL certificate upsell.** Free with how we're hosting.

Pay with your card. You'll get a confirmation email within a minute.

Send word, paste two records, *you're live.*

02

TELL ME

Text me you bought it

That's the whole step. One text. You do **not** need to share your Porkbun login with me. The domain stays in your account.

I'll then prep two short DNS records and send them back to you (usually same-day).

03

PASTE IN
DNS

Paste the records I send you

1. Log into Porkbun
2. Click **Account**, then **Domain Management**
3. Find your domain in the list, click **Details**
4. Scroll to **DNS Records**
5. Delete any default records that are already there (parking-page stuff)
6. Add the two records I send you (exact copy and paste, I'll spell it out)
7. Click **Save**

Within an hour (sometimes 5 minutes), your site is live at **elephantaes.com**. I'll confirm it's working and send you the link to share.

IF YOU GET STUCK

Text or email me at any point. There's no step here you can break permanently. The worst case is "we paste the record, wait an hour, and it didn't take, so we paste it again."

— THE NUMBERS

What it costs you, *ongoing.*

Domain	~\$11/yr	Porkbun, paid yearly. Auto-renew handles it for you.
Hosting	\$0	Netlify free tier. Handles way more traffic than you'll get.
SSL (the padlock)	\$0	Free with the hosting. Comes on automatically.
Total	~\$11/yr	Roughly \$1/mo. Square's per-order fee (2.9% + 30¢) is separate.

— KEEP THESE SAFE

Your Porkbun login

This is the keys to the kingdom. If you lose it, you lose the domain. A password manager is best (1Password, Bitwarden, the iPhone built-in one). At minimum, write it somewhere only you can find.

The renewal date

Porkbun emails you, but a calendar reminder is a good backup. With auto-renew on, you're covered.

— A FEW THINGS PEOPLE ASK

Why isn't the domain in Ryan's name?

Because it's your business. The domain should always be in the owner's name, not the developer's. If we ever stop working together, you keep everything with zero handoff drama.

Can I get email at @elephantaes.com later?

Yes, easily, when you want it. Google Workspace is \$6/user/mo, or Porkbun's own email is \$24/yr. Not urgent, and we can add it any time.

What if I want to move off Netlify someday?

ELEPHANTAES · GOING LIVE

You change those two DNS records to point somewhere else. Domain stays yours. Site files are yours. No lock-in anywhere.